

Book of Remembrance

David and Catherine (uch Thomas ap Richard) Roberts and Their Family

A Clean Annotated Edition

Original compilation by David D. Roberts (identified in the historical volume as David R. Roberts)

Modern editorial edition prepared from the Roberts family source collection



- Subject: Original title page of the Book of Remembrance
 - Intended caption: Original title page preserved in the Roberts family volume.
 - Suggested source/provenance: `source/DavidRoberts-Searchable.pdf`, PDF page 1.
 - Editorial note: Use the full page without cropping away manuscript or mounting evidence.
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Editor's Preface

David D. Roberts assembled this Book of Remembrance to preserve the history, faith, migrations, relationships, and records of his family. His work brought together family manuscripts, letters, church publications, recollections, photographs, and records that might otherwise have been separated or lost. This edition treats that achievement with gratitude and respect.

The original compiler worked with the evidence and translations available to him. Later access to the Welsh journal, the Robert D. Roberts English record, grave and cemetery evidence, family correspondence, and other documentary sources now permits some statements to be corrected, clarified, or enlarged. Those later findings are never silently substituted for the compiler's account. The historical compilation remains the base layer; modern editorial work appears separately and is labeled.

This first-pass draft establishes the complete editorial and section scaffold and completes the new edition's front matter. It also annotates the securely readable title, arrangement, source conventions, and selected front-matter claims. The family narrative beginning with Section A has not yet been rebuilt in this draft. That boundary is intentional: the surviving book contains 310 PDF pages, while the repository's established searchable extraction currently covers only PDF pages 1-68. Later sections require sequential source-image review before clean text can be responsibly published.

How to Use This Edition

Historical base text

Text labeled Original compilation represents what David D. Roberts recorded. Readable historical spelling and source-specific names are retained when they carry evidentiary value. Obvious mechanical inconsistencies may be regularized for reading only when the source is secure.

Editorial categories

Editor's correction identifies a claim for which stronger evidence supports a different reading.

Editor's clarification distinguishes people, names, places, dates, or source layers that the original wording could leave ambiguous.

Editor's note supplies concise historical or documentary context without changing the compiler's claim.

Evidence note identifies the source basis for a correction or clarification.

Uncertainty

Conflicting evidence is preserved. The terms confirmed, probable, possible, and unresolved describe the strength of an editorial conclusion; they do not erase the original statement. Missing or damaged source text is not reconstructed from a later retelling.

Images

This draft contains placeholders only. Each placeholder identifies a subject, intended caption, and suggested provenance field. No replacement or synthetic image has been inserted.

Principal Source Layers

1. The original Book of Remembrance, used as the base text and structure.
2. The David Roberts Welsh/shared journal and its modern English translation.
3. The Robert D. Roberts English family record and historical parallel text.
4. Grave, cemetery, and burial evidence already assembled in the project.
5. Family correspondence and documentary notes.
6. Ffestiniog branch and related Welsh Latter-day Saint evidence when independently relevant.
7. Secondary research aids, used as leads rather than final proof.

Original Compiler and Editorial Responsibility

The repository identifies the compiler as David D. Roberts, son of Robert D. Roberts and known in family context as "The Judge." The historical book itself commonly presents his name as David R. Roberts. Both forms are retained because the source form and canonical family identification answer different questions.

The compiler did not know Welsh and did not visit Wales. That context helps explain why he depended upon family translations, copied records, and information available through others. It is not a criticism of his care or purpose. Modern editorial corrections are benefits of later access, not judgments upon the original work.

Original Compiler's Front Matter

Original Title

Original compilation

Book of Remembrance of David and Catherine (uch Thomas ap Richard) Roberts, natives of Llanfrothen, Merionethshire, Wales, and their family.

Editor's clarification

The title and arrangement establish a multi-branch family record rather than a biography of one person. This edition preserves the complete A-L plan even though only the front matter is rebuilt in this draft.

Dedication

Source condition note

The surviving dedication scan begins in the middle of a sentence. The missing opening is not supplied. The readable portion emphasizes the compiler's wish that descendants know the faith, pioneering work, and family example of their forebears and preserve their history as a united record.

Original compilation - secure excerpts

If a family is to live in the earth as a distinctive entity, it must write and preserve its history - the record of its individual members, and its branches - of their experiences and of the dealings of God with them.

I feel an irresistible urge to perform this service of making available to posterity the records of our fathers and mothers.

Editor's note

These statements explain the compiler's method and tone. The annotated edition retains that family-centered purpose while separating later evidence from his historical voice.

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER - compiler portrait]

- Subject: David D. Roberts, compiler of the Book of Remembrance
- Intended caption: David D. Roberts, compiler of the Roberts family Book of Remembrance.
- Suggested source/provenance: Roberts family photograph collection; exact image and date to be selected later.
- Editorial note: Confirm the sitter and date before insertion; do not substitute a different David Roberts.

Preface

Original compilation - summary of the readable source

The compiler presents record keeping as a religious and family duty. He describes the earlier records kept by his grandfather David Roberts and his father Robert D. Roberts, explains his own effort to preserve and organize them, and

asks descendants to continue the record. He also describes acquiring records, photographs, family-group information, and other materials over many years.

Editor's note

The preface is an important provenance statement. It shows that the Book of Remembrance is itself a compilation from multiple earlier witnesses. Quotations copied into the book must therefore be compared with the surviving Welsh and English journals when exact wording, dates, or names matter.

Explanatory Notes and Source Abbreviations

Original compilation

The compiler explains that his grandfather David Roberts and father Robert D. Roberts both kept record books. He intended to preserve original material and marked copied passages with abbreviations. Securely readable abbreviations include:

- D. Rec. - record of David Roberts.
- R. Rec. - record of Robert D. Roberts.
- R. MS. - manuscripts of Robert D. Roberts.
- R. L. - copies of letters of Robert D. Roberts.
- D. N. - Deseret News.
- J. H. with a date - Journal History.
- B. M. with a date - British Mission record.
- M. S. with volume and page - Millennial Star.
- C. S. - church emigration or ship passenger register.
- H. O. - Historian's Office of The Church of Jesus Christ of Latter-day Saints.

Editor's clarification

These abbreviations identify the cited source category, but do not always establish that a surviving quotation is verbatim. This edition will compare copied passages with an extant journal or publication where available.

The Name "David R. Roberts"

Original compilation

The compiler states that his grandfather was recorded as David Roberts in Wales, including the Ffestiniog branch record and Welsh Latter-day Saint hymnbook. He proposes that David added the middle initial R after reaching Utah, perhaps to distinguish himself from other men named David Roberts aboard the S. Curling.

Editor's correction

The proposed timing is not fully established by the now-available signed evidence. The shared journal contains directly attributable signatures David R Roberts dated February 4 and April 6, 1858. They confirm his use of that form in Utah before his death on November 4, 1858, but do not establish exactly when or why he adopted it. The passenger explanation remains a family interpretation rather than a proven reason.

Evidence note

- David Roberts shared journal, PDF page 73, signed entry dated February 4, 1858.
- David Roberts shared journal, PDF page 76, two signed records dated April 6, 1858.
- Book of Remembrance, source PDF page 3, compiler's explanatory note.

The Hymn Initials "D. R."

Original compilation

The compiler identifies D. R. in the Welsh Latter-day Saint hymnbook with David Roberts.

Editor's clarification

The journal independently establishes David Roberts's strong poetic interest and bardic instruction. It does not directly identify the 1852 hymn, and the damaged verse on journal page 69 has not been connected to that hymn. The attribution remains a focused research question requiring comparison of the hymn text, printed attribution, genealogy-book text, and independent evidence.

Arrangement of the Original Book

1. Title page.
 2. Dedication.
 3. Preface.
 4. Explanatory notes.
 5. Arrangement of the book.
 6. Section A - Earliest history of ancestry and of the family.
 7. Section B - Robert D. and Hannah (Roberts) Roberts and family.
 8. Section C - Robert D. and Eliza (Neagle) Roberts and family.
 9. Section D - Thomas D. and Margaret G. (Davis) Roberts and family.
 10. Section E - Daniel and Sarah A. (Hughes) Roberts and family.
 11. Section F - William T. and Ann (Roberts) Hopkins and family.
 12. Section G - Taliesin and Elizabeth (Roberts) Hughes and family.
 13. Section H - Gomer and Jane (Roberts) Hughes and family.
 14. Section I - Genealogy of the family.
 15. Section J - Temple work activities.
 16. Section K - Family organization.
 17. Section L - Miscellaneous matters of family interest.
 18. Name and subject indexes.
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Section A - Earliest History of Ancestry and of the Family

Rebuild status

Not yet rebuilt in this first-pass draft. The next sequential pass begins here, using the original book as base and the completed Welsh/shared journal as a comparison witness.

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER - ancestral locality map]

- Subject: Llanfrothen, Ffestiniog, Beddgelert, Clynog, and associated family localities
- Intended caption: Principal north Wales localities appearing in the early Roberts family record.
- Suggested source/provenance: Later map prepared from verified place identifications; cartographic source to be recorded.
- Editorial note: Do not infer an ancestral residence solely from a nearby place-name occurrence.

Planned correction and clarification areas

- Robert Price / Roberts surname-transition evidence.
- David Roberts birth-date conflict: Welsh manuscript April 5, 1814; RDR April 14; signed 1858 account gives April 6.
- Exact historical Welsh name and place forms.
- Conversion, baptism, branch leadership, migration, and handcart chronology.
- Grave inscriptions, burial evidence, and corrected death dates.
- Distinction between original writing, historical translation/copy, and later synthesis.

Section B - Robert D. and Hannah (Roberts) Roberts and Family

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.



- Subject: Robert D. and Hannah (Roberts) Roberts family
- Intended caption: Robert D. and Hannah (Roberts) Roberts and family.
- Suggested source/provenance: Roberts family photograph collection; identities and date to be verified.

Section C - Robert D. and Eliza (Neagle) Roberts and Family

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Section D - Thomas D. and Margaret G. (Davis) Roberts and Family

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Section E - Daniel and Sarah A. (Hughes) Roberts and Family

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Section F - William T. and Ann (Roberts) Hopkins and Family

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Section G - Taliesin and Elizabeth (Roberts) Hughes and Family

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Section H - Gomer and Jane (Roberts) Hughes and Family

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Section I - Genealogy of the Family

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Editorial safeguard: journal page 72 names David's father as Robert Roberts but leaves his paternal grandfather unnamed; it does not identify Robert Price or Rhys Roberts as that grandfather.

Section J - Temple Work Activities

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Editorial safeguard: temple and proxy records will be used as secondary identification evidence and will not substitute for direct genealogical proof.

Section K - Family Organization

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Section L - Miscellaneous Matters of Family Interest

Status: scaffold only; not yet rebuilt.

Name Index

Status: reserved for generation after the narrative sections are rebuilt.

Subject Index

Status: reserved for generation after the narrative sections are rebuilt.

Section A Pilot: The Compiler Introduces the Earliest Record

Original source: Book of Remembrance, PDF page 9 (internal page A-1). This pilot ends before the compiler's historical English translation begins.

Original compiler narrative

It is most appropriate that this record should begin with a recital of the earliest writings known in the family, namely, the writings of Grandfather, David Roberts. His record book is in my possession, it having been given into my care by my father, Robert D. Roberts. It is written in the Welsh language and bears the marks of time. The record consists, in the most part, of poetry, as Grandfather was a poet. There are, however, a few pages of historical and genealogical data which have been translated from the Welsh into the English. The first translation was made by my father many years ago and recently I secured another translation by my friend, Mr. John Thomas of Ogden, Utah. I acted as scribe. I have compared the translations and they agree throughout. I am sure that the translation is very accurate, giving not only the letter and meaning but also the spirit of the original. The notes in brackets are inserted by me, by way of explanation. I have also inserted the headings.

(The translation is as follows.)

Editor's clarification

The compiler's English text is retained as a valuable historical translation and family witness. It is not the same layer as the project's modern English translation made directly from the Welsh manuscript. Welsh transcription, modern translation, and Robert D. Roberts historical English remain separate so agreements, normalizations, expansions, and conflicts can be evaluated openly.

Evidence note

The manuscript pages containing the early family narrative are now identified as David Roberts's own hand through comparison with directly signed 1858 samples elsewhere in the shared journal. This supports the compiler's central statement while allowing the wording and dates of the Welsh source to be checked independently.

Editorial categories used in the edition

- Editor's correction: stronger surviving evidence supports a specific correction.
- Editor's clarification: wording or source identity can be made more precise without rejecting the compiler's account.
- Evidence note: identifies the basis for a claim or explains a source relationship.
- Unresolved question: records a genuine conflict without choosing unsupported certainty.

[IMAGE PLACEHOLDER - David Roberts Welsh journal manuscript]

- Intended caption: Early Welsh family-history pages in the shared Roberts journal, attributed to David Roberts through signed-sample handwriting comparison.
- Suggested source/provenance: original manuscript image and PDF page reference; custody and reproduction credit to be supplied.
- Editorial placement: after the compiler's introduction, before the historical English translation.